



Dell has launched a new series of netbooks for school and college kids. This series is called the Latitude 2100 and has nice rubberised rugged bodies. These netbooks come in a choice of colours

Dell Studio XPS 16

16-inch heavyweight

The Studio XPS 16 sports a 16-inch screen, with an Intel Core 2 Duo T9400 processor, and an ATI HD 3670 GPU. By default this laptop comes an Intel Core 2 Duo P8600, but Dell allows you to upgrade to the T9550.

The back of the lid has a strip of leather, aluminium and plastic, giving it a slick look. The e-SATA/USB combo port, optical

drive, card reader slot and a USB port is located on the right side. Two headphone ports and one microphone port are located on the left side, with a display port, VGA-out, HDMI-out and two USB ports. There are touch buttons present above the keyboard that control certain functions such as Wi-Fi, multimedia controls and the eject button. The keyboard is a full QWERTY, with well-spaced keys that have a white backlight.

With the exhaust at the back, it's sad to see Dell overlook the fact that the lid, when open, blocks it. This makes for one hot laptop after a few hours of use — quite a silly, and easily avoidable design flaw.

This particular laptop has a 16-inch WUXGA RGB LED display that has a resolution

of 1920 x 1080, which basically means a full-HD screen. RGB LED displays have the best colour gamut for notebook displays. The viewing angles of this screen are also great, and you can see clearly from either side — the glossy screen, however, undoes all this goodness. This display, again, is an upgrade, and the default configuration has a WXGA WLED display (1366 x 768).

The RGB LED is a joy to watch movies and HD clips on, but we noticed some colour banding, and in areas where yellows and blues blended, there were some really weird greens being formed.

The onboard speakers are pretty loud, and they're located on either side of the keyboard.

The battery only lasted for 1 hour and 10 min, but that's what you expect from high-performance desktop replacements.

The Dell Studio XPS 16 starts at Rs. 67,900, with the configuration Dell sent us, the price went up to Rs. 78,394, which includes a 500 GB hard drive and the WUXGA RGB LED screen.

Contact

Dell India

Phone: 1-800-425-4026

Email: dell_enquiries@dell.com

Web site: www.dell.co.in

Price: Rs. 78,394

Specifications

Dimensions (W x H x D): 384.9 x

24.1 x 254.6 mm

Weight: 2.91 kg

Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo

T9400 @ 2.53 GHz

GPU: ATI Mobility Radeon HD 3670

RATINGS

Features8
Performance8.5
Build Quality7
Value for money6.5
Overall7.5



Norton Utilities 2009

Simple and effective

Symantec's net spans over a large area of system maintenance and security suites. The Norton Utilities suite is designed to keep your system in check.

Installation, registering and updating of the suite takes place in one single go. The design of the interface is clean and very simple to use for anybody who hasn't seen any of the recent Norton applications.

One of the interesting features is the custom search wizard that lets you create your own scan to check and delete scattered and empty folders. Another great feature is the service manager, which lets you choose from two service presets. Norton can turn off the services not needed to save memory.

Making changes to the startup applications list is also possible for all other users. This is something that people can do through the Windows Registry,

but Norton Utilities makes it less complicated. Other than these, the typical set of registry and folder cleaning features are available along with application history clearing. Support for third-party applications and even browsers such as Firefox and Opera are present.

There's even an in-built performance test that can be useful to check any performance difference before and after a complete system cleanup.

The help file is a very basic quickstart guide, and more detailed documentation is available as a PDF file on the disk, but that lacks any images to explain things.

The application only uses around 15 to 16 MB of RAM while running. Unlike antivirus software, Norton Utilities doesn't run all the time, except if you want it to constantly monitor the registry for any changes being made to it.



The price for Norton Utilities is set to Rs. 1,880 for a single user and three PC license. The pricing is average and with regular updates, this can be a nice utility to have around especially if you're the type of person who installs and uninstalls software very often.

Contact

Symantec India

Phone: +91-22-3067 1400

Web site: www.symantec.com

Price: Rs. 1,880

Requirements

Windows Vista / Windows XP SP2 and above, 300 MHz processor, 256 MB RAM, 200 MB disk space

RATINGS

Features7
Performance7
Ease of use8
Value for money6.5
Overall7